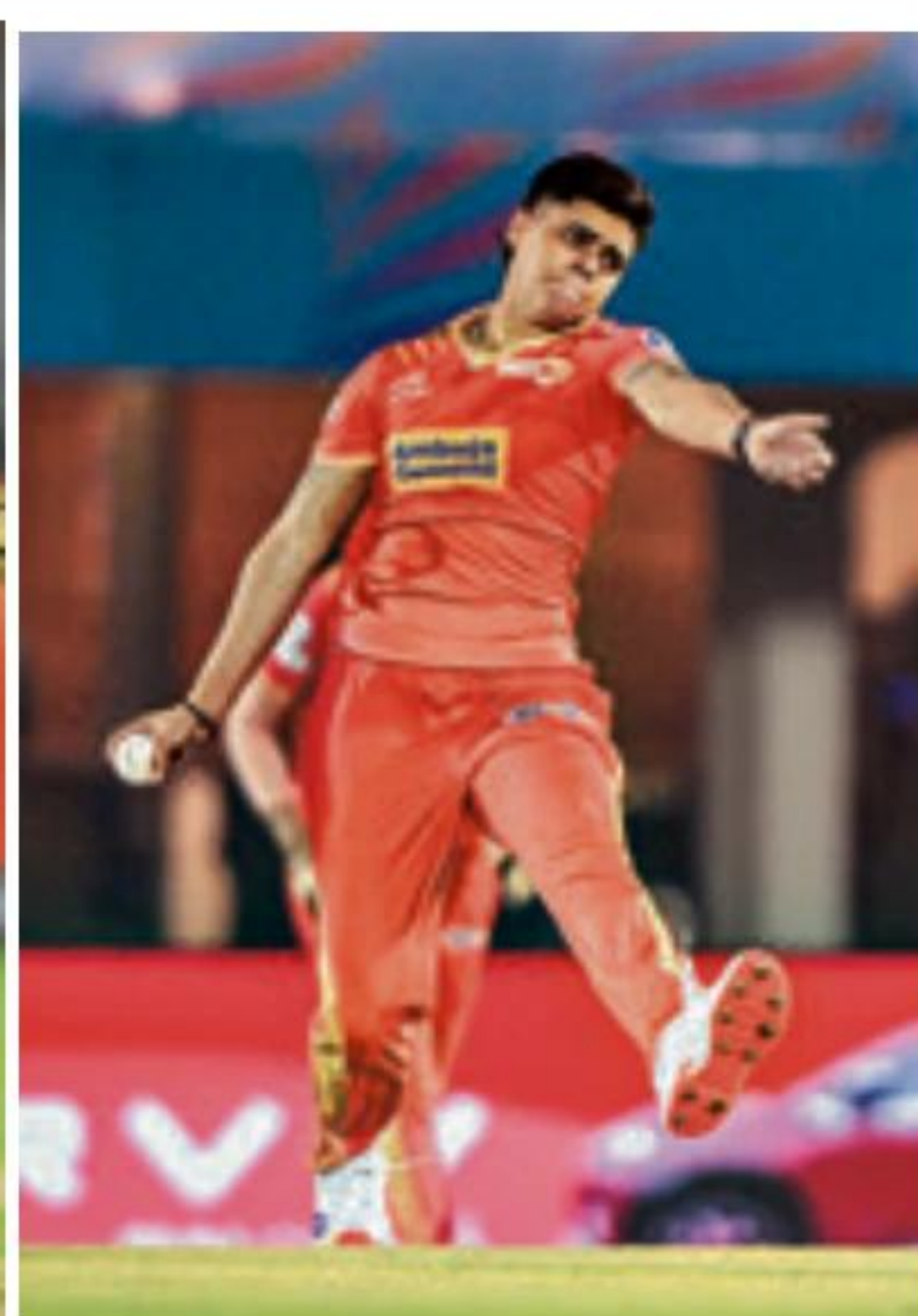




1



PTI

Uncapped batter Anushka Sharma (**above, left**) has won her maiden India call-up for the five-match T20I series against South Africa, a key tune-up ahead of the ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026. The youngster impressed in her debut WPL season, amassing 177 runs in seven outings at a strike rate of 129.19. Fast bowler Kashvee Gautam (**above, right**), already capped in ODIs and Tests, could make her T20I debut as well. The series begins on April 17 in Durban and runs through Johannesburg before concluding in Benoni on April 27.



2

AP

Cricket Ireland has unveiled a landmark home summer, packed with high-profile fixtures for both its men's and women's teams. The men's side will headline the season with a historic Test against New Zealand, followed by a marquee white-ball series against reigning ICC Men's T20 World Cup champion India in late June. A five-match ODI series against Afghanistan in August adds further weight to a busy calendar. The women's team, meanwhile, begins its ICC Women's Championship campaign, hosting India, New Zealand, Pakistan, and West Indies, while touring England, Australia, Zimbabwe, and Sri Lanka.



3

FILE PIC: SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Australia sealed a dominant 3-0 sweep of the Women's T20I series, defeating West Indies by 40 runs via the DLS method in a rain-hit finale in Kingstown. The victory was powered by Georgia Voll's (**in pic**) maiden T20I century, which propelled Australia to a formidable 212. West Indies, reduced to 61/3 in 10 overs, saw its chase cut short as persistent rain forced a result under DLS. The visitor had already stamped its authority earlier in the series with convincing wins by 43 and 17 runs.

Former Pakistan captain Sarfaraz Ahmed has retired from international cricket. The wicketkeeper-batter played 54 Tests, 117 ODIs and 61 T20Is, and amassed 6,164 runs, including six centuries and 35 fifties. Behind the stumps, Sarfaraz finished with 315 catches and 56 stumpings. He also captained Pakistan in 100 international matches across formats (50 ODIs, 37 T20Is, 13 Tests), notably leading the side to its first and only ICC Champions Trophy title in 2017.



4

REUTERS